

Supplemental Project Information

John B. DeValles Elementary School, New Bedford, MA

The project initially was to perform a Feasibility Study through Schematic Design Study for the John B. DeValles Elementary School in the City's south end. The school has been serving the City's south end district for more than 100 years with varying grade configurations over the years.



Currently, it serves approximately 300 students in Grades K - 5. The Study was for increased enrollment of 400 students and included consideration of consolidating the DeValles School with another 100+ year old school, as a renovated, or new, 760 student school. The Building Committee elected to pursue a 760-student school as the most cost effective and educationally appropriate solution, following analysis of 16 different options.

The site is bordered by Buzzards Bay to the south and dense residential neighborhoods to the east, north, and south, and the desire to maintain a neighborhood school, the challenge was to determine whether the consolidated school would be successful as 1) an addition and renovation on the existing building and site, 2) by expanding the existing parcel by purchasing adjacent properties, or 3) by locating the project on another parcel altogether. The Team worked with the City to identify potential sites within the school(s) catchment area. Two sites were identified - 1 adjacent parcel allowed expanding the site to over 4 acres and 1 separate site with an Activity and Use Limitation (AUL) with the DEP comprising approximately 7 acres.



Ultimately, the Building Committee elected to pursue a new building on the new site, which was approved by the MSBA Board of Directors in September 2023. The City purchased the site in November 2023 and approved funding for the project in February 2024 and an early site enabling package involved preparing the site for the new school and

removing the AUL. The building project is in bidding phase and expected to be completed and occupied in November 2026. The project is targeting LEED Gold certification and features a 690kW photovoltaic array (340 rooftop and 350 canopy); all electric, zero fossil fuel design; and geo-thermal ground source heat pump heating and cooling system. The project is pursuing credits through the Inflation Reduction Act (IRA) to offset the geothermal installation cost, and targeting an Energy Use Intensity (EUI) below 25 to qualify for the local utility company highest incentives/credits. Total credits are anticipated to be in the range of \$7-8MM. The project is expected to realize a 56.6% energy cost savings before renewable energy offsets, and with those offsets it is expected to be Net Zero.